
CARCASSONNE

ASIAN CUP 2026

Official Tournament Rules

Draw	August 1, 2026
Tournament dates	August 3–September 13, 2026
Participants	Seven national teams
Group Stage	One group; four matches per team
Finals	Championship Match and Bronze Medal Match
Match format	Five best-of-three duels (5 vs 5)
Platform	Board Game Arena (BGA)

The third edition of the Carcassonne Asian Cup Online Championship brings together national teams from Asia and Oceania. These rules apply throughout the 2026 competition.

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1 Tournament Overview

1.1 Dates and participants

The draw will take place on **August 1, 2026**. The tournament will run from **August 3 through September 13, 2026**.

The seven participating teams, listed in the order of the National Team Ranking used for the draw, are:

Rank	Team	Rating	Rank	Team	Rating
1	Japan	1837	5	Taiwan	1554
2	China	1813	6	Australia	1321
3	Hong Kong	1670	7	Vietnam	1298
4	Thailand	1598			

1.2 Competition structure

- All seven teams compete in a **single group**.
- Each team plays **four matches against four different opponents**.
- The Group Stage schedule is created through the balanced draw described in Section 4.
- After the Group Stage:
 - **1st vs 2nd** — Championship Match;
 - **3rd vs 4th** — Bronze Medal Match.
- Teams finishing fifth through seventh retain their relative Group Stage positions in the final ranking.

2 Eligibility and Team Requirements

2.1 Eligibility

Each team must consist of players from the same country, or from a single region where Carcassonne is published in its own language. Only one team per country or region is allowed. Team members must have been born in, or currently live in, the country or region they represent.

2.2 Registration

The captain registers the team through the [Asian Cup 2026 Player Hub](#). When building the team roster, the captain selects players who have already been added to their association or creates records for players who have not yet been added. Captains are responsible for keeping this information accurate and up to date throughout the tournament.

2.3 Team composition

- A team must have at least **8 players** and no more than **10 players**.
- At least eight team members must play at least one duel during the Group Stage. A team that fails to meet this requirement loses one match win (**MW**) in the final Group Stage standings.
- Each team must appoint one captain.
- During the Group Stage only, a team may add players up to the ten-player limit or replace players. A player who has already played in at least one match may not be replaced. Every change requires prior notice to the organizers.
- Each team must have access to a Premium BGA account capable of creating the tournament match. The account holder does not have to be in that match's lineup.

2.4 Captain's responsibility

The captain must ensure that every team member understands and accepts these rules and later organizer updates. The captain handles team communication, scheduling, lineups, and results.

3 Scheduling and Lineups

3.1 Official schedule

The organizer-published schedule determines the Group Stage rounds and the dates of the Championship and Bronze Medal Matches. Captains arrange the exact date and time of each assigned match within the permitted round window.

All submitted dates and times must use **UTC+8**. Captains may use [Savvy Time](#) to avoid conversion errors.

3.2 Scheduling a match

- Captains must agree on and submit their match date and time by **23:59 UTC+8 on Wednesday** of the applicable match week through the [Asian Cup 2026 Player Hub](#).
- A match may be played earlier, provided that the date, time, and both lineups are submitted at least 24 hours before it begins.
- If no date and time are submitted by the deadline, the match is automatically scheduled for **Sunday at 19:00 UTC+8**.
- Captains should reply promptly to scheduling messages, even when a final time has not yet been agreed.

3.3 Submitting lineups

Each captain submits a lineup of five players, assigned to positions 1–5, through the [Asian Cup 2026 Player Hub](#) at least **24 hours before the match**. The submitted lineups are then published on carcassonne.gg/Asian-Cup-2026.

Position 1 on one team plays Position 1 on the other team, and so on through Position 5. After submission, no more than one player may be changed, and only because of a major unforeseen event with organizer approval.

Failure to submit a lineup on time may be penalized as a match loss: **0–5 duels and 0–10 games**.

4 Balanced Group Stage Draw

4.1 Ranking basis

The draw uses the current [National Team Ranking](#). Instead of producing a completely random schedule, it gives every team a balanced set of opponents while preserving randomness.

For each team, the other six teams are divided into:

- the **Top 3** — the three highest-rated available opponents; and
- the **Lower 3** — the three lowest-rated available opponents.

Each team is drawn to play:

- **two opponents from its Top 3**; and
- **two opponents from its Lower 3**.

Because the opponent sets are calculated separately for every team, a pairing may belong to different categories from the two teams' perspectives.

4.2 Opponent pools

Team	Top 3 opponents	Lower 3 opponents
Japan	China, Hong Kong, Thailand	Taiwan, Australia, Vietnam
China	Japan, Hong Kong, Thailand	Taiwan, Australia, Vietnam
Hong Kong	Japan, China, Thailand	Taiwan, Australia, Vietnam
Thailand	Japan, China, Hong Kong	Taiwan, Australia, Vietnam
Taiwan	Japan, China, Hong Kong	Thailand, Australia, Vietnam
Australia	Japan, China, Hong Kong	Thailand, Taiwan, Vietnam
Vietnam	Japan, China, Hong Kong	Thailand, Taiwan, Australia

Examples. For Japan, the Top 3 are China, Hong Kong, and Thailand; the Lower 3 are Taiwan, Australia, and Vietnam. For Taiwan, the Top 3 are Japan, China, and Hong Kong; the Lower 3 are Thailand, Australia, and Vietnam.

4.3 Draw validity

A schedule is valid only if all of the following are true:

1. every team has exactly four opponents;
2. no two teams meet more than once in the Group Stage;
3. every scheduled pairing is reciprocal;
4. from each team's own perspective, exactly two opponents are from its Top 3 and exactly two are from its Lower 3.

This prevents any team from receiving an exceptionally difficult or exceptionally easy schedule while still leaving room for randomness in the draw.

Example of a Valid Balanced Draw

In the matrix below, **1** means that the match is scheduled and **0** means that it is not. Cell colors show the opponent category from the row team’s perspective.

	Japan	China	Hong Kong	Thailand	Taiwan	Australia	Vietnam	Top 3	Lower 3	Total
Japan	—	1	1	0	0	1	1	2	2	4
China	1	—	0	1	1	1	0	2	2	4
Hong Kong	1	0	—	1	1	0	1	2	2	4
Thailand	0	1	1	—	1	1	0	2	2	4
Taiwan	0	1	1	1	—	0	1	2	2	4
Australia	1	1	0	1	0	—	1	2	2	4
Vietnam	1	0	1	0	1	1	—	2	2	4

Top 3 opponent

Lower 3 opponent

Same team

This matrix is an example of a valid outcome, not the official 2026 schedule.

5 Match Format

5.1 Five simultaneous duels

A team match consists of **five duels**, normally played simultaneously. Each duel is a best-of-three encounter between one player from each team.

- The first player to win two games wins the duel.
- If a player wins the first two games, the duel ends 2–0 and no third result is recorded.
- The team that wins at least three of the five duels wins the match.

5.2 BGA tournament settings

Matches are played in BGA tournament mode with **15 minutes per player**. The starting player does not necessarily alternate between games, so the same player may start two or all three games of a duel.

If a duel has already been decided after two games but BGA launches a third game, both players must enter it and jointly abandon it.

5.3 Tied game score

Every game must produce a winner for tournament purposes. If the final board score is tied, the player who **did not start the game** is the winner.

6 Group Stage Standings

6.1 Recorded statistics

MP	Matches Played	MW	Matches Won
DW	Duels Won	DL	Duels Lost
GW	Games Won	GL	Games Lost
DD	Duels Difference ($DW - DL$)	GD	Games Difference ($GW - GL$)

One match win is recorded for each team match won, one duel win for each duel won, and one game win for each game won.

6.2 Tie-break order

Final Group Stage positions are determined in the following order:

1. **MW (Matches Won)** — number of team matches won.
2. **DD (Duels Difference)** — difference between Duels Won and Duels Lost.
3. **DW (Duels Won)** — total number of duels won.
4. **GD (Games Difference)** — difference between Games Won and Games Lost.
5. **GW (Games Won)** — total number of games won.
6. **OMW (Opponents' Matches Won)** — total number of team matches won by all opponents faced during the Group Stage.
7. **ODD (Opponents' Duels Difference)** — combined difference between DW and DL of all opponents faced during the Group Stage.
8. **ODW (Opponents' Duels Won)** — total number of duels won by all opponents faced during the Group Stage.

Buchholz principle. OMW, ODD, and ODW measure the results achieved by the opponents a team actually faced. They reward strength of schedule and are applied only after the team's own match, duel, and game results.

6.3 Medal matches and final positions

The first- and second-placed teams contest the Championship Match. Its winner finishes first and its loser finishes second. The third- and fourth-placed teams contest the Bronze Medal Match. Its winner finishes third and its loser finishes fourth.

7 Clock Rules

If a player runs out of time during a game, that player loses the game. This is a loss for that game only, not automatically for the entire duel.

A player has run out of time when the time shown after completing a turn and synchronizing with the server is zero or negative. If possible, the player should concede so that BGA awards the win correctly. If there is doubt, the red "time penalty" clock shown in the game results is decisive. If both players run out of time, the player who ran out first loses.

Players should reduce connection risks by arranging a reliable internet connection and, where possible, keeping a backup connection such as a mobile hotspot available. Any duel affected by a serious technical issue must be completed as soon as possible and reported to the organizers.

8 Courtesy and Fair Play

8.1 Player conduct

Players and spectators must remain courteous and respectful. Captains should encourage prompt communication and avoid waiting until the final moment to resolve scheduling issues.

8.2 Discarded tiles

When BGA automatically discards a tile that cannot be placed legally, the opponent may not notice it. The player should inform the opponent in the game chat whenever this happens.

8.3 Unauthorized assistance

Players must play their own games without advice, coaching, or outside assistance. Tile-counting and memory aids—including apps, spreadsheets, notes, or pen and paper—are strictly forbidden. Players are also responsible for avoiding unsolicited help.

An individual or team using inappropriate assistance may be removed from the tournament and may also be excluded from future editions.

8.4 Conceding

Except when a player has run out of time or when these rules explicitly require abandoning an unnecessary third game, games must be played to completion.

9 Results, Absences, and Incidents

9.1 Reporting results

Results are recorded automatically from BGA data. Within **24 hours after the match ends**, both captains must review them in the [Asian Cup 2026 Player Hub](#). Either captain may submit a required correction there for approval by the opposing captain; unresolved discrepancies must be referred to the organizers.

9.2 How incidents are recorded

- **Normal game:** the final score and winner are imported automatically from BGA. No action is required unless the imported data are incorrect.
- **Tied board score:** the non-starting player is the game winner. Submit a correction if the automatic result does not reflect this rule.
- **Time loss:** the game is a win for the opponent. Submit a correction if necessary.
- **No-show:** if a player has not appeared within 15 minutes of the scheduled time, the opponent wins the duel 2-0; the captain must submit the required correction through the Player Hub.
- **Duel decided in two games:** no third-game result is recorded.

9.3 Before play begins

Players must join promptly and verify the tournament settings before play. BGA may close a tournament place when a player does not enter within the platform's joining window. Once play has begun, claims based on settings that could have been checked beforehand may be rejected.

10 Duties, Disputes, and Prizes

10.1 Duties of team captains

- Ensure that all players understand and follow the rules and organizer updates.
- Remind team members to behave respectfully as players and spectators.
- Communicate with the opposing captain and tournament organizers.
- Submit match dates, times, and lineups, and review automatically recorded results, by their deadlines.
- Notify the organizers about approved roster changes and significant match incidents.

10.2 Dispute Arbitration Zone

The Dispute Arbitration Zone (DAZ) considers disputes and determines the appropriate resolution. The organizers may also act against players or teams engaging in unfair play or conduct contrary to these rules.

When submitting a dispute, provide the match, duel, game link, relevant times, screenshots, and a concise description of the issue. Organizer contact details and the official communication channel will be published with the tournament materials.

10.3 Prizes

The winning team will be crowned the **Carcassonne Asian Cup 2026 Champion** and recognized as the leading online national team in Asia and Oceania for this edition.

10.4 Questions

Questions about these rules should be sent through the official organizer contact channel. Tournament announcements and updates will be published on carcassonne.gg/Asian-Cup-2026.